

Chapter 66_2: Blazing Fire

"At that time, I was also just a young child¹, not understanding the burden on my shoulders, unwilling to leave home," Liu Wenzhu said softly. "But with you accompanying me, the days away from home weren't too difficult to endure."

"I still remember how we loved to sneak off to the back mountain to catch butterflies. We would keep the butterflies we caught in glass bottles, but after catching several bottles full of butterflies, they all died." Liu Wenzhu couldn't help but smile. "And there were the words we carved in the corner of the ancestral hall, saying that in the future we would definitely save the common people."

Ning Fuyi also laughed. As she laughed, she turned her head away, waiting for her eyes to dry.

"Someone like me who's worthless—only you and Senior Brother Rongjin are willing to treat me well," Ning Fuyi sighed.

"You're talking nonsense again." Liu Wenzhu's beautiful almond eyes were full of reproach, and she weakly pushed Ning Fuyi, nearly breaking her shoulder. "I've told you before that you're not worthless."

"Why should people with low cultivation be bullied and looked down upon? Those people have cultivated their immortality into a dog's belly!" Liu Wenzhu spoke gently as she scolded. "People who love you don't care whether you're powerful or not. Senior Brother Rongjin and I don't care, and the former sect master wouldn't either."

"We only want you to live peacefully and happily." Liu Wenzhu's voice grew weaker and weaker. "What we care about is that you are Ning Fuyi."

Ning Fuyi's nose became increasingly sour, making it difficult to breathe: "I also want you all to stay alive."

Liu Wenzhu let out a very low, wind chime-like laugh.

The ghostly wailing became more and more piercing. They could no longer hear each other's voices. The vengeful spirits' power was too strong, greedily sucking away their remaining will.

Ning Fuyi closed her eyes.

As she had expected, the woman who had been as soft as a puddle of water suddenly moved, leaving her body. Rolling hot air and the coldness from the vengeful spirits replaced the woman's presence.

She slightly lifted her eyelids and, through countless swarming pale black vengeful spirits, saw that willow-like body struggling forward with clenched teeth.

Ning Fuyi didn't speak, but silently drew Xiangsi from the ground and slowly walked toward Liu Wenzhu.

The surroundings were truly too piercing. Liu Wenzhu couldn't hear Ning Fuyi's footsteps at all. Ning Fuyi easily approached her, raised her hand, and struck the back of Liu Wenzhu's neck with the sword hilt.

Liu Wenzhu naturally had no defense and fell silently. Ning Fuyi caught her back with one hand and carefully placed her on the ground.

Liu Wenzhu's face was once again covered with a bluish-black color; her peach-juice-like lips had lost their blood color, and her breathing was so weak it seemed she might die the next second. Ning Fuyi knew she couldn't delay any longer, so her gaze became increasingly cold and hard. The divine sword spun once in her palm before being forcefully thrust into the mud again.

"Xiangsi, help me." Ning Fuyi pleaded with her divine sword. The divine sword rang out with clear sword song and suddenly burst forth with radiance again, driving away the surrounding vengeful spirits.

Ning Fuyi took one last look at Liu Wenzhu, then stood up and walked toward the depths of the cave.

The vengeful spirits were still pouncing on her, but she no longer cared, allowing them to feed from her body everywhere. As the mud under her feet became drier and harder, the surrounding temperature also became increasingly scorching, so much so that even sweat evaporated quickly.

Ning Fuyi's cheeks immediately became dry and cracked. She forcefully squeezed her dry eyes and turned a corner, where scalding hot air hit her face.

This place was an arched cavern with a bottomless pit below. Raging fire continuously churned within the pit, occasionally spewing out strings of sparks. The flames were so scorching that even the rocks above the pit were burned red-hot.

When one was still a zhang² away from the great pit, their cheeks and eyes already felt as if they were being burned. Ning Fuyi enveloped herself with immortal power before she could continue forward.

When she reached the edge of the great pit, the vengeful spirits' wailing had disappeared. In her ears was only the whooshing sound of the raging fire burning, occasionally accompanied by the sound of something exploding. A strand of hair fell from her head, and the moment it left the protection of her immortal power, it had already turned into a wisp of green smoke.

Ning Fuyi had to admit that imagining the feeling of falling into fire from a distance was far from matching the fear of standing here and looking at it. Ning Fuyi thought she was no longer afraid of anything, yet she still felt some thoughts of retreat.

What about Liu Wenzhu then? A pampered young lady of the Liu family who had been spoiled since childhood—in her previous life, for her sake, had jumped into this blazing fire before her eyes.

Perhaps because death was imminent and everything else was just fleeting clouds, Ning Fuyi's mood suddenly became strangely relaxed. Her thoughts even drifted far away, and she began to consider whether Liu Wenzhu would also be so angry that she would become a demon when she woke up.

Probably not. She was such a gentle and strong woman, unlike herself.

Actually, this was quite good. She had protected the person she wanted to protect, and there would be no more suffering in the future. The only regret was that she couldn't personally kill Li Zhao'an with her own hands.

The burning flames made one dizzy. Ning Fuyi unconsciously gripped the prayer bead on her wrist and suddenly thought of someone else.

She didn't know where Chu Qingqiu was now, or how she would react when she learned of this matter. She had clearly instructed her to stay well in the mountains before leaving. When she learned that she had left, she would definitely be angry again.

Ning Fuyi could imagine what she looked like when angry—nothing more than red-rimmed eyes, speaking some unpleasant words in an icy cold manner.

By the time she arrived, she would certainly have already turned to ash. She didn't know what her reaction would be.

Above the great pit with flames reaching the sky, a woman in blue robes stood straight, her hair disheveled behind her ears, her lips red as sand, her long lashes like fans. The firelight danced in her night-black eyes, dispelling some of her sinister aura.

Ning Fuyi looked at the prayer bead illuminated by the firelight, took it off and threw it on the ground, the corners of her lips curling up.

"Ning Changfeng, I'm going to die again," she murmured to herself, her voice drifting. "I should have known to ask you to wait for me, so you wouldn't be lonely during reincarnation."

Having said this, she dispersed her immortal power without the slightest hesitation, took a step forward, and fell into the blazing fire that scorched heaven and earth.

Footnotes:

¹垂髫 (chuí tiáo) - Literally "hanging hair," referring to a young child around 3-8 years old when children's hair hangs down

² zhang (丈) - A traditional Chinese unit of measurement, approximately 3.33 meters or about 11 feet